

COMMUNICATION STYLES



LEAD SMARTER, NOT HARDER: HOW TO ALIGN YOUR TEAM'S WORKING STYLES FOR BETTER RESULTS

Having conducted behavioral assessments with thousands of professionals in the financial services sector, we have analyzed the results over the past year to gain insights into working styles across the industry.

Our data reveals that finance professionals typically exhibit a strong capacity for critical thinking and a results-oriented mindset; however, there is room for improvement regarding team collaboration and support. Furthermore, we have identified a balanced mix of outgoing and reserved personalities within these organizations. This diversity suggests that while critical thinking and task delivery are prioritized, a wide range of interpersonal engagement styles contributes to the workplace dynamic.



Multiple working styles within an organization are essential for cultivating a dynamic and effective work environment. Varied personalities offer distinct perspectives, problem-solving approaches, and communication styles, enhancing creativity and innovation. This variety balances strengths and weaknesses and improves team collaboration and adaptability when facing challenges. Moreover, a blend of behavioral types fosters a more inclusive and resilient organizational culture, promoting empathy and mutual understanding among team members. Leveraging diverse personality traits leads to a more versatile and successful business.

As a leader, you can take specific steps to create an environment that embraces and fully leverages your team's diverse working styles.

UNDERSTAND YOURSELF

Begin by developing a deeper understanding of your working style, whether through assessments or feedback from colleagues. The more you comprehend your communication style, problem-solving approach, and personal motivators, the better you can anticipate your reactions in various situations. With this heightened self-awareness, you can choose your responses deliberately rather than being driven solely by instinct. Consider reflecting on the following questions:

- When I communicate, do I prioritize speaking or listening?
- Do I prefer high-level summaries or detailed explanations?
- Do I prefer to dive into tasks immediately or choose a brief period of small talk first?
- How do I typically react under pressure or stress?
- Do I prefer thoroughly analyzing a problem before addressing it, or do I favor a hands-on approach that allows for learning through action?



UNDERSTAND OTHERS

Invest time in getting to know your team members. Recognize that no working style is inherently right or wrong; these behaviors stem from motivations, values, life experiences, and contexts.

By acknowledging your colleagues' diverse styles and needs, you can better appreciate their unique contributions. This understanding often reveals how their approaches can complement your own.



Consider what drives their behavior:

- Are they focused on achieving quick results or emphasize accuracy and thorough analysis?
- Do they prefer to brainstorm collaboratively or process ideas independently before sharing?
- How do they navigate difficult conversations—do they withdraw, or do they tackle conflict head-on?

A photograph of two women sitting at a table, looking at a laptop screen. The woman on the left has blonde hair and is wearing a red blazer over a white top. The woman on the right has brown hair and is wearing a dark blazer. They are in a modern office setting with a brick wall and plants in the background.

MASTER THE ART OF FLEXIBILITY

Frequently, our default behaviors attract like-minded individuals while inadvertently alienating those who differ. It is important to recognize behaviors that we may unconsciously reward or discourage. Your objective should not be to alter others' personalities, nor should you feel compelled to change your own. Instead, strive for flexibility in your approach, which can yield more favorable outcomes when collaborating with various styles. For example:

- Team members less inclined to participate actively in brainstorming sessions may benefit from alternative avenues for sharing ideas that feel more comfortable.
- Detail-oriented colleagues may require clear deadlines and comprehensive context to prioritize effectively.
- Supportive, team-oriented individuals often seek opportunities to personally connect with you and their peers. Take an interest in their lives beyond their professional roles.

In summary, the most influential leaders recognize and harness their team members' diverse strengths and working styles, fostering better collaboration. Awareness of your style and that of your colleagues is crucial for building stronger working relationships and facilitating effective communication. This understanding empowers team members to navigate and adapt their styles to various situations, enhancing communication with colleagues and clients and improving conflict resolution.

Hatwell's tailored one-to-one executive coaching and group training programs can help strengthen your leadership and team collaboration through effective communication. Contact us today to start your journey.

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